



The Hardest Job in the Lodge

The Almoner

RESPONSIBILITIES

The office least fought over and most needed. What the Almoner actually does, where the money comes from, and why the job gets harder as a lodge ages.

ON THE TABLE

The Almoner's jewel — a scrip purse

HOW THE PAPER RUNS

0:00	Opening
1:00	The jewel
2:15	What the Almoner actually does
4:30	The difference nobody can state
6:00	Where the help actually comes from
7:45	Why it gets harder
9:00	Closing

THREE THINGS TO TAKE AWAY

- 1 The jewel is a scrip purse — a pilgrim's satchel — charged with a heart.
- 2 Almoner looks inward to our own; Charity Steward looks outward to what we give.
- 3 The Masonic Charitable Foundation (2016) covers far more than poverty, and the Almoner can start the application.

IF YOU ARE ASKED

Almoner or Charity Steward?

Almoner looks inward — our brethren, widows and dependants. Charity Steward looks outward — what we give. Sometimes combined in a small lodge.

Must a brother be destitute to get help?

No. The Masonic Charitable Foundation supports a far wider range of need than relief of poverty.

Can the Almoner start an application?

Yes, and very often he must, because the brethren who need it most will not ask.

When was the MCF formed?

2016, amalgamating four long-standing masonic charities.

What's on the jewel?

A scrip purse — a pilgrim's satchel — charged with a heart.

SOURCES

- Masonic Charitable Foundation — published guidance on what support is available and how to apply
- UGLE Book of Constitutions — the office and its duties
- Your Provincial Almoner, who will brief any lodge Almoner who asks

Every paper is drawn from openly published masonic literature. Nothing here discloses the esoteric work of any degree; all of it is safe to deliver with visitors present, provided the visitors are brethren.

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